ERA 20

The Movement Peaks

1963 – 1965

The March on Washington · landmark civil rights laws

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the civil rights movement translate protest into permanent law?

KEY TERMS

The March on Washington · the Civil Rights Act of 1964 · Selma · the Voting Rights Act of 1965

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 8.10 · AMSCO Ch. 8.10

FROM PROTEST TO LAW

The Movement Peaks

August 28, 1963

The March on Washington



- In August 1963, some **250,000** people gathered at the Lincoln Memorial.
- **Dr. King** delivered his '**I Have a Dream**' speech.
- It was the largest demonstration the capital had ever seen—and a moral turning point.

The Civil Rights Act of 1964

- After Kennedy's assassination, President **Johnson** pushed the bill through Congress.
- The **Civil Rights Act of 1964** banned segregation in **public accommodations**.
- It outlawed **discrimination** in employment based on race, sex, religion, or origin.



SECTION

The Right to Vote

Selma & the Voting Rights Act



- In **Selma**, marchers demanding the vote were beaten on '**Bloody Sunday**.'
- Televised violence shocked the nation into action.
- The **Voting Rights Act of 1965** banned literacy tests and protected Black voters.

What the Movement Won

I

End of Legal Segregation

The **Civil Rights Act** outlawed Jim Crow in public life.

II

The Right to Vote

The **Voting Rights Act** and 24th Amendment restored Black voting power.

III

A Model for the World

Nonviolent protest became a template for movements everywhere.

Organizing in Mississippi

EVENT

Freedom Summer (1964)

Volunteers, many of them white Northern college students, joined SNCC and CORE to register Black voters in Mississippi. The murders of James Chaney, Andrew Goodman and Michael Schwerner drew national attention.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Movement Peaks

1. The **March on Washington** and King's '**I Have a Dream**' speech marked the movement's moral peak.
2. The **Civil Rights Act of 1964** outlawed segregation and **discrimination**.
3. After **Selma**, the **Voting Rights Act of 1965** secured the ballot—dismantling the legal structure of Jim Crow.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Movement Peaks

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how nonviolent protest pressured Congress to pass landmark **civil rights laws**.

COMPARISON

Compare the **Civil Rights Act of 1964** and the **Voting Rights Act of 1965**.

ARGUMENTATION

Was federal **legislation** or grassroots **protest** more essential to the movement's success? Defend a claim.

Up next — **Lesson 50: Black Power & a Movement Divided**